Rules reference

what Mausritter used to cover

Winter Burrow · GM

Saves

STAT	COVERS
STR	Force, endurance, holding on
DEX	Speed, balance, dodging, moving quietly
WIL	Nerve, noticing, persuading

Only roll when she's trying to avoid something bad, and say what failing will cost before she rolls. Equal or under: done. Up to 5 over: at a cost. More: fails. A save with a named failure (save or wet) is pass or fail.

Advantage when she's well prepared or equipped. **Disadvantage** when she's badly placed, badly equipped, or a condition says so.

Opposed. When she and someone else want the same thing, both save. The lowest roll that succeeds wins. If both fail, neither gets it.

Luck rolls

For anything that isn't her doing, like whether the cat is out or Nibs has honey today, give it a chance in 6 and roll d6. Equal or under, it happens. 1-in-6 is unlikely, 3-in-6 even, 5-in-6 likely.

Picking a cost

For a failure, or the middle band.

COST	SIZE
Damage	d4 minor, d6 dangerous, d8 serious, d10 and up rare
Time	An hour on the track
Cold	A Warmth step
A thing	A random pack slot (d6) is lost, or mark 1–3 uses
A condition	Exhausted, Injured, Wet
Attention	A noise. Roll an encounter

Usage

Most things have 3 uses. At three, it's broken or spent.

THING	MARKS A USE
Weapons, bark shield	After a fight, on a d6 roll of 4–6
Stick, anything improvised	Every fight
Matches	Each fire
Lantern	Each Night it's lit
Anything else	When used in a way that could break or spend it

Repair. A Make at the workbench clears every use on one thing, for 1 of what it's made from.

Fights, from the GM's side

- A fight takes minutes and marks no hour. The Warmth roll after it is its cost.
- A foe with no WIL listed has WIL 10.
- A foe that's plainly outmatched makes a WIL save when the fight starts, or flees. A group makes one when half of it is down.
- A foe that fails its STR save is beaten: it flees or dies. Critical damage in a stat block replaces that, and replaces her Injured-and-down.
- Hampered (in a web, grabbed, through cover): d4. Set up (stuck, unaware, a trick that worked): d12.

Stats at 0

STR 0	She goes down and wakes at STR 1, Frostbitten
DEX 0	She can't move until a night at home brings a point back
WIL 0	She's out of the scene, as if she'd gone down

She never dies. Going down: next Morning, somewhere worse, 1 HP, Warmth d4, Injured, all but one Chilled cleared, bundles lost.

Who talks

Mice, the neighbours and Murder talk. Birds, cats and spiders don't. When a creature's mood isn't obvious, roll 2d6.

2D6	MOOD	ASK YOURSELF
2	**Hostile**	How has she angered it?
3–5	**Unfriendly**	How could it be appeased?
6–8	**Unsure**	What would win it over?
9–11	**Talkative**	What would it trade?
12	**Helpful**	How can it help?

Time and rest

- A task is an hour: gathering, searching, cutting through a web, going around the ants.
- A look around, a short talk or a fight is minutes and marks nothing.
- HP comes back only with sleep. There are no short rests.
- A night without sleep is Exhausted.

Beetles

Ground beetles winter packed together in the leaf litter and under bark. A swarm is **d6+4**. Count them, don't track HP.

- **Her hits** down one beetle per 2 damage, rounding up. A 5 downs three, a set-up d12 up to six.
- **Their turn:** they bite as one, 1 damage per beetle on her, at most 2.
- **At half**, the rest scatter. In the open on a Bitter cold or Snowstorm day, she acts first.

Not in this game

Magic, pips and prices, XP, levels and grit, hirelings and warbands, banks, hexes and watches, Mausritter's weather table.

Rulings

When something isn't covered, make a call, write it here, and keep it.